

Class 10th | English



First Flight

TWO STORIES ABOUT FLYING

LECTURE - 2

QUESTIONS

1. Why was the young Seagull afraid to fly? Do you think all young birds are afraid to make their first flight, or are some birds more timid than others? Do you think a human baby also finds it a challenge to take its first step?

ANS. The young seagull was afraid to fly because he felt that his wings would not support him and he would fall from a great height.

Yes, when something is done for the first time, it is a bit challenging and fearful. All birds get afraid while taking their first flight. However, it is also a fact that some birds are more timid than others and consequently take more time to fly.

Just like a bird, a human baby is also afraid of taking the first step and finds it challenging.

QUESTIONS

2. "The sight of the food maddened him." What does this suggest? What compelled the young Seagull to finally fly?

ANS. This suggests that the young seagull was hungry and when he saw food, his hunger increased.

It was his hunger that ultimately compelled him to fly. His hunger intensified when he saw his mother tearing up a piece of fish that lay at her feet. He cried to her, begging her to get some food. So, she flew towards him with a fish in her beak and stopped at some distance. Unable to control himself, the young Seagull dived for food. Naturally, his wings spread out and he began to fly.

QUESTIONS

3. "They were beckoning to him, calling shrilly." Why did the seagull's father and mother threaten him and cajole him to fly?

ANS. Unlike his siblings, the poor seagull could not gather enough courage to take his first flight. Thus, his parents taunted him for being a coward. They threatened and cajoled him so that he might take his first flight.

QUESTIONS

4. Have you ever had a similar experience, where your parents encouraged you to do something that you were too scared to try?

ANS. Yes, I had a similar experience while learning to ride a bicycle in Class VI. In my initial attempts, I fell down every time and developed a fear of cycling which was difficult to overcome.

My father encouraged me to overcome the fear and helped in learning cycling. He took me on a small hill near our village, made me sit and asked me to put my hands on the handle and feet on the pedals. When he pushed me, the cycle moved and I enjoyed it without fear, which developed my confidence. Thus, I overcame my fear of cycling and started riding a cycle regularly after a little practice.

QUESTIONS

5. In the case of a bird flying, it seems a natural act, and a foregone conclusion that it should succeed.

In the examples you have given in answer to the previous question, was your success guaranteed, or was it important for you to try, regardless of a possibility of failure?

ANS. In the example I have given as an answer to the previous question, it is evident that initially my success was not guaranteed. I was afraid of failure and did not even want to try cycling. But I was encouraged and motivated to do so. I had to try, regardless of the possibility of failure. I had to put in efforts and hard work. With the willingness and determination, my success became guaranteed as when someone is determined, success is assured.

QUESTIONS

✓
6. He stood at the edge of the ledge on one leg and closed his eyes because _____.

- (a) he was feeling sleepy
- (b) it was a natural habit of seagulls
- (c) he wanted to get the attention of his family ✓✓
- (d) he was afraid of the his family

QUESTIONS

ANS. (c) he wanted to get the attention of his family

QUESTIONS

8. "He had in fact seen his older brother catch his first herring and devour it."

"How did 'he' feel?"

- 1. Angry ✗
- 2. Greedy ✗
- 3. Jealous ✓
- 4. Hungry ✓

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 3 and 4 ✓
- (d) 4 and 1

QUESTIONS

ANS. (c) 3 and 4

QUESTIONS

9. When did young seagull's mother scream derisively at the young seagull?

- (a) When he denied for flying ✗
- (b) When he acted sleeping ✗
- (c) When he begged her for food ✓
- (d) None of the above ✗

QUESTIONS

ANS. (c) When he begged her for food

QUESTIONS

11

11. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

But he kept calling plaintively, and after a minute or so he uttered a joyful scream. His mother had picked up a piece of the fish and was flying across to him with it. He leaned out eagerly, tapping the rock with his feet, trying to get nearer to her as she flew across. But when she was just opposite to him, she halted, her wings motionless, the piece of fish in her beak almost within reach of his beak. He waited a moment in surprise, wondering why she did not come nearer, and then maddened by hunger, he dived at the fish. With a loud scream he fell outwards and downwards into space. Then a monstrous terror seized him and his heart stood still. He could hear nothing. But it only lasted a minute.

QUESTIONS

i. Read (a) - (c) and choose the option which shows the shift in emotion the seagull experiences from the beginning to the end of the extract.

- (a) From calm to fearful**
- (b) From anxious to nervous**
- (c) From mournful to petrified**

QUESTIONS

ANS. (c) From mournful to petrified

QUESTIONS

ii. Why was the young seagull fearful of flying?
How did he finally fly?

ANS. The young seagull was fearful of flying because he thought that his wings would not work and he would fall down from a great height into the deep sea. He finally flew because of his extreme hunger.

QUESTIONS

- iii.** What of these factors were not responsible for the young seagull learning to fly?
- (a)** (a) The continuous efforts of his mother and father
 - (b)** (b) The depth and vastness of the ocean beneath him
 - (c)** (c) The hunger and weakness that was maddening him
 - (d)** (d) The success of his siblings in diving and catching prey

QUESTIONS

ANS. (b) The depth and vastness of the ocean beneath him

QUESTIONS

iv. Why did 'it' last only a minute?

ANS. The fear felt by the young seagull lasted only a minute because soon his wings stretched outwards and he started to fly.

QUESTIONS

12. Why did the young seagull pretend to fall asleep on the brink of the ledge?

ANS. The young seagull pretended to fall asleep on the brink of the ledge because he wanted to draw the attention of his family who were ignoring him. He wanted his family to show some sympathy and provide him food as he was very hungry.

QUESTIONS

13. The sight of the food maddened him.' What does this suggest?

ANS. The phrase "The sight of the food maddened him" suggests that the young seagull was very hungry. As the young seagull was afraid to fly, his parents refused to give him any food. So, when he saw food, his hunger increased.

QUESTIONS

14. Describe the young seagull's first flight.

ANS. As the young seagull fell from the ledge, he was filled with fear. But soon, his wings spread out and he found himself flying. Upon realising that he was finally flying, the young seagull was overjoyed. He screamed with joy as he was no longer afraid of flying.

QUESTIONS

15. The young seagull's mother was very clever. Do you agree? Justify your answer.

ANS. The young seagull's mother was very clever. She knew that her child, the young seagull had been hungry for more than 24 hours. So, he could be lured to fly. Using this as her opportunity, she comes near the ledge with food. However, she stayed on the edge. As she had predicted, her child was hungry and to satisfy his hunger, he jumped from the cliff and started to fly.

QUESTIONS

16. Describe the young seagull's emotions when he flew over the sea.

ANS. When the young seagull flew over the sea, he felt terror at once but the next moment his fear of flying was gone. He spread his wings wide in the air. He flew over the sea screaming loudly with happiness in success of his first flight.

QUESTIONS

- 17.** His father and mother had come around calling to him shrilly, upbraiding him, threatening to let him starve on his ledge unless he flew away. In the above line 'His First Flight' do you think the seagull's parents took the right approach to make him fly? In 100-120 words, justify your stance with two reasons.

ANS. No, I believe that their approach was incorrect because they let their anger take the decision for how to teach the young seagull. This might have made him feel abandoned and unsupported. The parents should have accepted his fear instead of threatening him and let his siblings tease him for it. Rather, they taunted him for his cowardice and isolated him. This added to his fear which affected his confidence and discouraged him.

He quietly hid inside the little hole under the ledge. This made him feel that he would never be able to fly like his brothers and sister.

QUESTIONS

However, I also understand that the parents were worried about their child and wanted him to accept his natural trait.

They did not know how to get the young seagull to fly. As a result, they had to depend on such means to get the young seagull to fly.

QUESTIONS

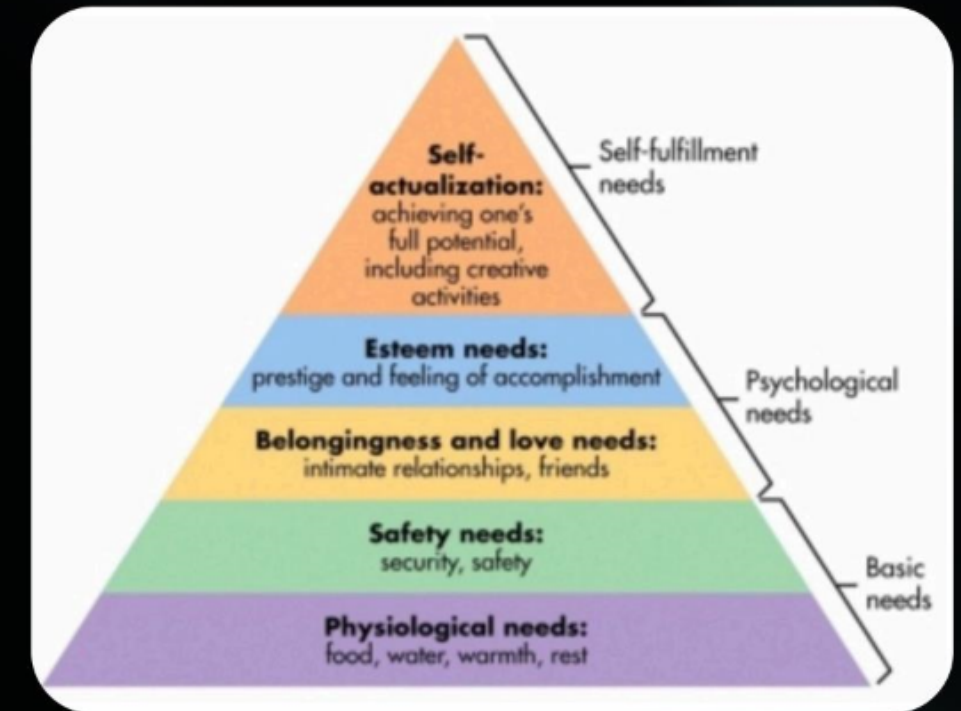
- 18.** A noted author, Richard Bach wrote - "For most gulls it was not flying that mattered, but eating. For this gull, though, it was not eating that mattered, but flight."
Evaluate this statement with respect to the young seagull.

ANS.

H/W - 2

QUESTIONS

- 19.** Look at the image of Maslow's hierarchy of needs. Abraham Maslow devised a theory of motivation that shows the basic needs at the bottom and more advanced needs as you move up. It includes the theory that fundamental needs must be met before an individual can be motivated to achieve higher order needs. Where in this hierarchy of needs, would you locate the young seagull's first flight? Justify your response.



HW-3

QUESTIONS

ANS. The young seagull's first flight would be located at the bottom of the pyramid under physiological needs.

As the German proverbs say- 'Wait is a hard word to the hungry and 'A hungry belly has no ears'. A hungry living being cannot think of anything else except food. It is evident from the story that one can put even one's life to danger to satisfy one's hunger. Similarly, the seagull did not care about his life and forgot his fear while jumping off the ledge to take hold of the fish in his mother's beak to satisfy his hunger.

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